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A source book on Tiv religion

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[PB 4 November 1951 Sengev] I was talking with WanGbenger today [she reminded me forcibly of my mother; I worked out a joking relationship with her], and she brought up the fact that the mbatsav had stolen some things from our huts. I asked her how she knew it was the mbatsav (this is typical Tiv teasing, implying that if she knows so much, she must "know" a lot more). She replied--why did she have to pretend with me. I had so much tsav that surely I knew who it was: it's a thing of being a man, therefore I was holding out by not telling who it was. I told her that I knew some women who grew tsav--that they would have to have done so to keep from being killed long ago. WanGbenger laughed uproariously at this--so did everybody else around.

754
Sorcery

[LB 3 February 1950 MbaDuku] MbaInyi (Chenge's wife no. 2) has a small bald spot on her head which she says appeared quite suddenly. She says it is the mbatsav who are responsible for such things, and since once they start to get at you, you cannot tell where they will stop, she is going to tell Kyagba about it as soon as she has a chance to, and he will make them stop.

754
Sorcery

[LB 20 March 1950] A girl at Nor's, Agogo, showed me the road--she had heard me talking with Iyordzua about Gesa's funeral, and on the path she told me that the other day, at the dance they had had at Nor's, I was lucky I went home early, because when the others stayed until just after dark, they found lots of mbatsav on the path as they went home. They shied rocks at them and were able to get through safely. She added, "MbaGor won't kill us. The  176 rest of MbaDuku will kill us. So we go travelling among them, but we do not eat anything. MbaGor, however, is different."

754
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